electronic media or disseminate in any other manner, the result of any exit poll during the period notified by the Election Commission in this regard.

"Exit-poll" is an opinion survey regarding how electors have voted at an election or how all the electors have performed with regard to the identification of a political party or candidate in an election.

Time-Limit for Submitting a Case for Disqualification In 2009[19], a provision was made for the simplification of the procedure for disqualification of a person found guilty of corrupt practices. It provided for a three-month time-limit within which the specified authority will have to submit the case of a person found guilty of corrupt practice to the President for determination of the question of disqualification.

All Officials Included in Corrupt Practice In 2009[20], a provision was made for the inclusion of all officials, whether in the government service or not, appointed or deputed by the Election Commission in connection with the conduct of elections, within the scope of corrupt practice of obtaining any assistance by a candidate for the furtherance of the prospects of his/her election.

Increase in Security Deposit In 2009[21], the amount of security deposit to be paid by the candidates contesting elections to the Lok Sabha was increased from ₹10,000 to ₹25,000 for the general candidates and from ₹5,000 to ₹12,500 for SC and ST candidates. Similarly, the security deposit in the case of elections to the state legislative assembly was increased from ₹5,000 to ₹10,000 for the general candidates and from ₹2,500 to ₹5,000 for the SC and ST candidates. This was done in order to check the multiplicity of non-serious candidates.

Appellate Authority within the District In 2009[22], a provision was made for appointment of an appellate authority within the district against the orders of the Electoral Registration Officers, instead of the Chief Electoral Officer of the state. Thus, an appeal against any order of the Electoral Registration Officer of a constituency (during continuous updation of the electoral roll) will now lie before the District Magistrate or Additional District Magistrate or Executive Magistrate or District Collector or an officer of equivalent rank. A further appeal against any order of the District Magistrate or Additional District Magistrate will now lie before the Chief Electoral Officer of the state.

Voting Rights to Citizens of India Living Abroad In 2010[23], a provision was made to confer voting rights to the citizens of India residing outside India due to various reasons. Accordingly, every citizen of India – (a) whose name is not included in the electoral roll (b) who has not acquired the citizenship of any other country (c) who is absent from his/her place of ordinary residence in India owing to his/her employment, education or otherwise outside India (whether temporarily or not) – shall be entitled to have his/her name registered in the electoral roll in the Parliamentary/Assembly constituency in which his/her place of residence in India as mentioned in his/her passport is located.

Online Enrolment in the Electoral Roll In 2013, a provision was made for online filing of applications for enrolment in the electoral roll. For this purpose, the Central Government, after consulting the Election Commission, made the rules known as the Registration of the Electors (Amendment) Rules, 2013. These rules made certain amendments in the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

Introduction of NOTA Option[24] According to the directions of Supreme Court, the Election Commission made provision in the ballot papers/EVMs for None of the Above (NOTA) option so that the voters who come to the polling booth and decide not to vote for any of the candidates in the fray, are able to exercise their right not to vote for such candidates while maintaining the secrecy of their ballot. The